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E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 2: Pronouns, word meaning and finding details – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to say who or what a pronoun refers to, work out an unknown word from the sentences around it, and find a detail when the question uses different words from the text. These are AC1.3, AC1.4 and AC3.1.

Materials: Handouts 2A, 2B and 2C, one per learner. Coloured pens or highlighters if available.

Activity 1: Who is 'he'? What is 'it'? (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Write on the board: *Rosa has a brother. He lives in Leeds. She visits him every month.* Ask who *He* is, who *She* is and who *him* is. Draw an arrow from each pronoun back to its noun.
2. Teach the rule in three steps and leave it on the board: look back, not forward; check singular or plural; check person or thing.
3. Write a second example: Mr Khan gave his daughter a key. She put it in her bag. Ask who She is and what it is. Show the clues: She is a woman or girl, so it is the daughter, not Mr Khan; it is one thing, not a person, so it is the key. Exam questions only use pronouns with one clear answer.
4. Hand out 2A. Do item 1 together, drawing the arrows on the board. Learners complete items 2 to 5 alone, drawing arrows on the paper before they write anything.
5. Feedback at the board. Invite learners up to draw the arrows. For item 2, stress that *it* appears twice and both mean the letter.

Activity 2: Read and track the pronouns (20 minutes)

1. Hand out 2B. Learners read the text once, silently, for the story. Ask two gist questions: What did Farid get? What does he do on Saturdays now?
2. Read the text aloud while learners follow. Stop at each bold pronoun and ask the class to shout the noun. Do not confirm yet.
3. Pairs answer the pronoun questions on 2C, section A. They must draw the arrow in the text first.
4. Feedback. For question 2, ask why the answer is not the piece of paper. Answer: a piece of paper cannot be ready after three Saturdays of repairs. Meaning has to make sense as well as grammar.

Activity 3: Guess the word from its neighbours (30 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Write *rusty* on the board. Ask who knows it. Tell those who do to stay quiet.
2. Ask the others to find the word in paragraph 3 and read the sentences before and after. Collect clues on the board: the bikes are old; Farid must repair it first. Ask: is a rusty bicycle in good or bad condition? Establish the meaning from the clues alone.
3. Give the method a name, *read around the word*, and write three steps: read the sentence before and after; decide if the word is good or bad, a thing or an action; try each option in the sentence and see which makes sense.
4. Go through the worked example on 2C, section B (noisy helps with crowded). Pairs then do questions 5–8: find the word in the text, underline the words before and after that help, then circle the answer. No phones or dictionaries.
5. Pairs then answer the multiple-choice questions underneath.
6. Feedback. For each question, ask which words in the text helped before the answer. Then test the method: substitute the chosen option into the sentence and read it aloud. Does it still make sense?

Activity 4: Find the detail when the words are different (25 minutes)

1. Write on the board: *Text: nearly an hour. Question: almost 60 minutes.* Explain that exam questions rarely copy the text. Learners must look for the same idea in different words.

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2. Quick oral matching. Say a phrase and learners find the matching words in the text: *a place to stay for people with no home* (hostel); *someone who works for free* (volunteer); *every week on the same day* (every Saturday); *without paying* (free).
3. Learners answer 2C, section C, alone in ten minutes. Beside each answer they write the paragraph number where they found it.
4. Pairs compare paragraph numbers before answers. Class feedback: for each question, one learner reads out the sentence from the text and another says which words in the question mean the same.

Activity 5: Be the examiner (20 minutes)

1. Each pair writes one new four-option question about the text: either a pronoun question or a detail question. The rule is that the question must not copy more than two words in a row from the text.
2. Pairs swap questions with another pair and answer them.
3. Choose three good questions and put them on the board. The class answers and says which wrong option was the most tempting, and why.
4. Close by asking each learner to finish the sentence: “When I do not know a word in the exam, I will…”

Answer key, Lesson 2

- **2A:** 1 the two brothers. 2 Ahmed; the letter. 3 Nasra; her neighbours. 4 the bus; the passengers. 5 Mr Chen; the students; the form.
- **2C Section A:** 1 B, 2 C, 3 D, 4 A.
- **2C Section B words that help:** worked example: crowded (noisy, a workshop full of people); patient (Farid had never fixed anything, but she taught him); mend (you must repair it, change a tyre); frightened (busy roads, so he took a lesson); with confidence (after the lesson, the opposite of frightened). 5 B, 6 C, 7 D, 8 B.
- **2C Section C:** 9 B (paragraph 1), 10 C (paragraph 2), 11 B (paragraph 3), 12 A (paragraph 4), 13 C (paragraph 5).